

GROUPS IN ORGANIZATION



-NILAM SANGROULA



AGENDA

- Concept
- Types of groups
- Group Processes

Concept of Groups

Understanding of the dynamics of group behavior is important for understanding of the organizational behavior. A group consists of two or more people coming together. They interact and are interdependent on each other. They share similar interests. They achieve particular objectives.

Robbins:

A group is defined as two or more individuals, interacting and interdependent, who have come together to achieve particular objectives.

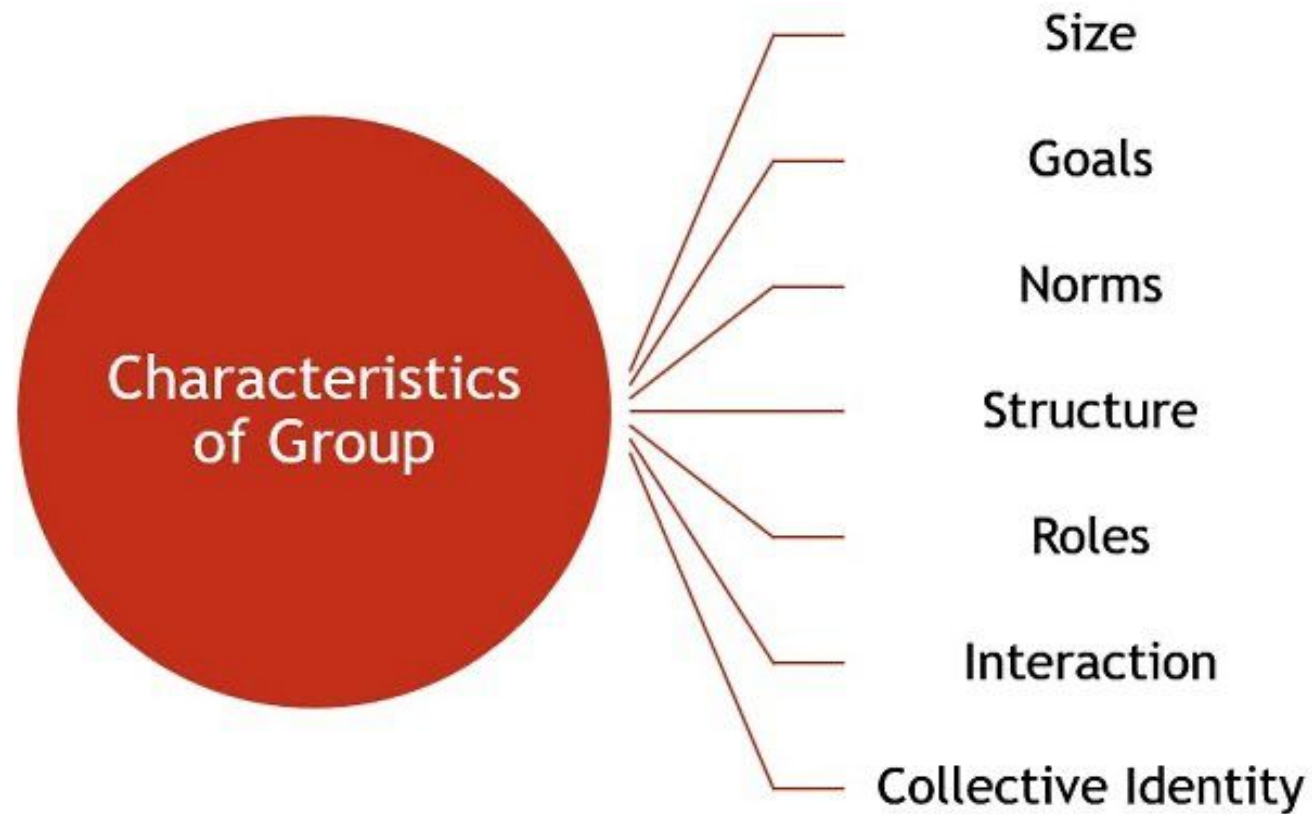
Arnold and Feldman:

A work group is a collection of two or more people who interact with each other, share similar interests, and come together to accomplish some work activity.



Characteristics of Group

GROUPS IN ORGANIZATION



Why people join group?

Security:

Reduce the insecurity of "standing alone"; feel stronger, fewer self doubts, and more resistant to threats

Status:

Inclusion in a group viewed by outsiders as important; provides recognition and status

Self-esteem:

Provides feelings of self-worth to group members, in addition to conveying status to outsiders



Affiliation:

Fulfills social needs, enjoys regular interaction; can be primary source for fulfilling need for affiliation

Power:

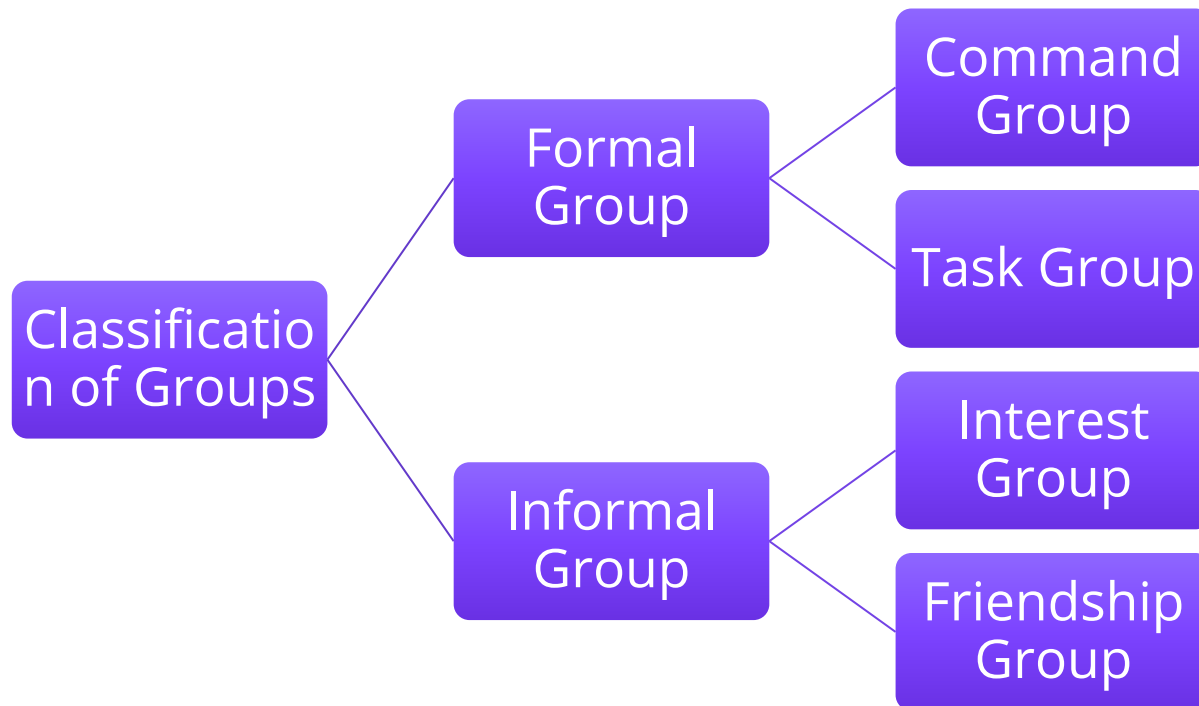
What cannot be achieved individually often becomes possible; power in numbers

Goal achievement:

Some tasks require more than one person; need to pool talents knowledge or power to complete the job. in such instances management may rely on the use of a formal group



Classification of Groups



Formal Group: It is designated work group defined by the organization's structure. It is established under legal or formal authority. It is work oriented. Formal group can be classified into:

- **Command Group:** It is formed by the subordinates reporting directly to a manager. It is determined by organizational chart. It is permanent. Example of such a group may be a production manager and his subordinates in his department, a college principal and teachers and so on.
- **Task Group:** It consists of people working together to complete a particular task. It is also organizationally determined. It is temporary. It is formed to complete a specific work assessment. Example: All the sales staff members together subordinate to the manager of the shop.

Therefore, all command groups are task groups but all task groups are not command groups.



Informal Groups: It is a group that is neither formally structured nor organizationally determined. It evolves naturally in the work environment. The membership is voluntary. One person can be a member of several informal groups. It can be subdivided into:

- ❑ Interest group: affiliate to attain a specific objective of shared interest. Eg. government subsidies for farmers
- ❑ Friendship group: members have one or more common characteristics. It is a social alliance. Eg. Supporting sports team.



Difference between formal and informal group

Formal Groups	Informal Groups
1. It is official and planned 2. Its primary focus is position 3. Is uses formal hierarchy for communication 4. Rules guide member behavior 5. Source of power is delegated from top management 6. Control is through formal reward and punishment 7. It is based on authority and responsibility relationship 8. It is a part of the bigger organization system	1. It is unofficial and unplanned 2. Its primary focus is person 3. Is uses grapevine for communication 4. Norms guide member behavior 5. Source of power is group 6. Control is through informal reward and sanction 7. It is based on power and politics 8. It coexists with formal organization.



Group Processes

Group process refers to how an organization's members work together to get things done.

Typically, organizations spend a great deal of time and energy setting and striving to reach goals but give little consideration to what is happening between and to the group's greatest resource – it's members. While working hard to achieve results, it is critical that members' needs be addressed. The following are the processes that go in within the group. They consists of:

- Communication: It is the patterns used by members for transfer of information and understanding of meaning.





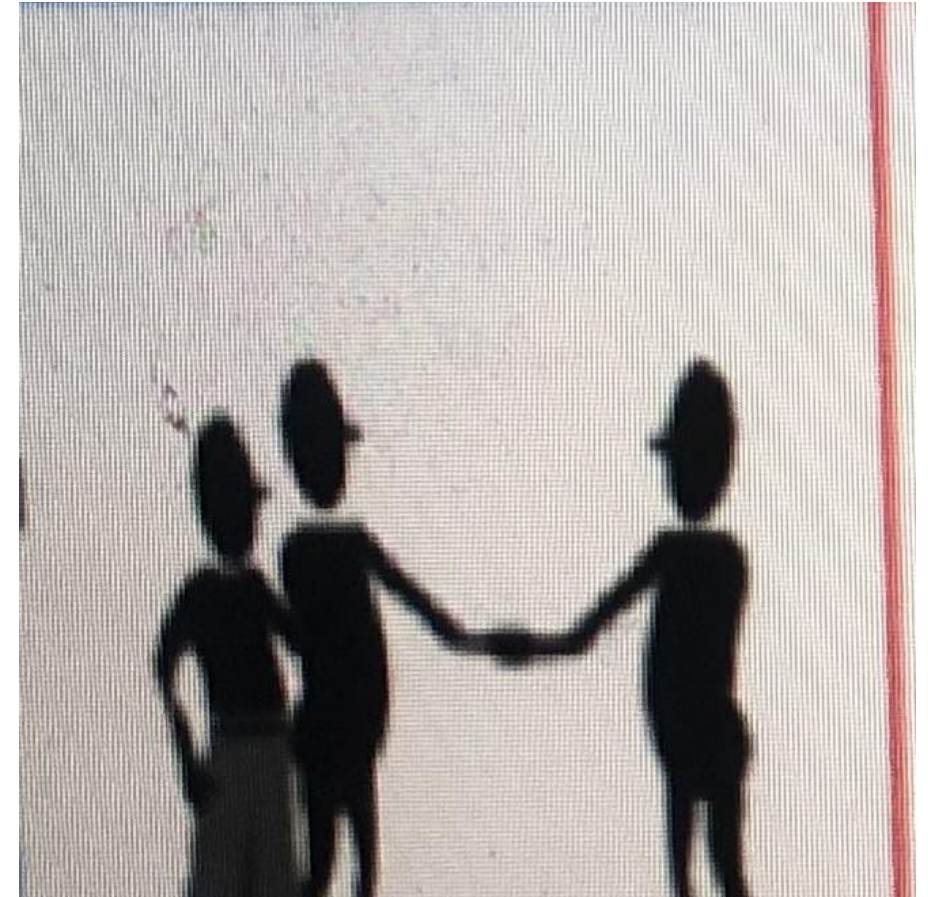
- ❑ Leadership: it is the ability of leaders to provide direction towards the goal achievement.
- ❑ Power: It is the capacity to influence the behavior of others
- ❑ Conflicts: It is all kinds of opposition or antagonistic interactions between two parties.
- ❑ Group decision making: Collective decision making by group by choosing from among two or more alternatives.

Stages of Formation of Group

The process of group development involves five important Stages:

Forming Stage:

- ❑ The first stage for almost every group is an orientation stage.
- ❑ This stage is marked by a great deal of caution, courtesy confusion.
- ❑ The formal leader exerts a great influence in structuring the group and shaping members expectations
- ❑ At the end of this stage interpersonal relationships are established and members begin to identify themselves with the group.



Storming stage: (move angrily and forcefully)

- This stage is characterized by conflict, criticism, and confrontation (meet an opponent face to face) among group members.
- Such conflicts may arise due to differences in perception
- In case the conflicts become extremely intense (force) & dysfunctional (unable to deal) the group may dissolve or continue as an ineffective group.

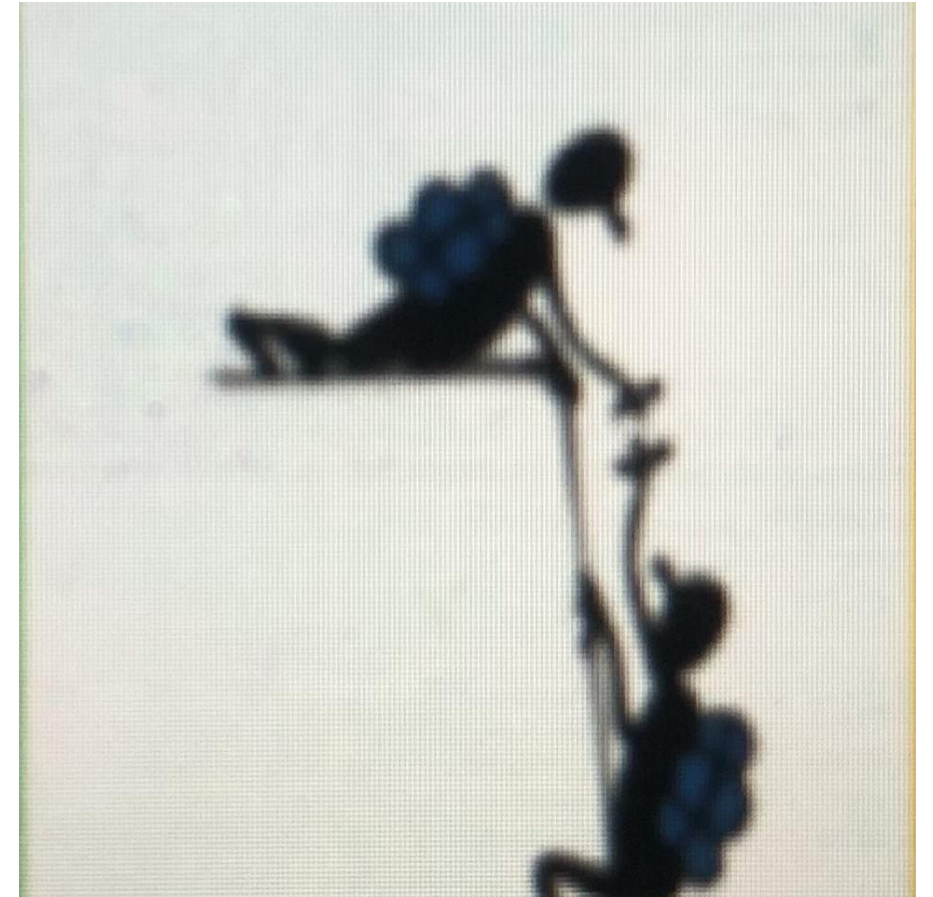


Norming stage:

At this stage one person emerges powerful leader

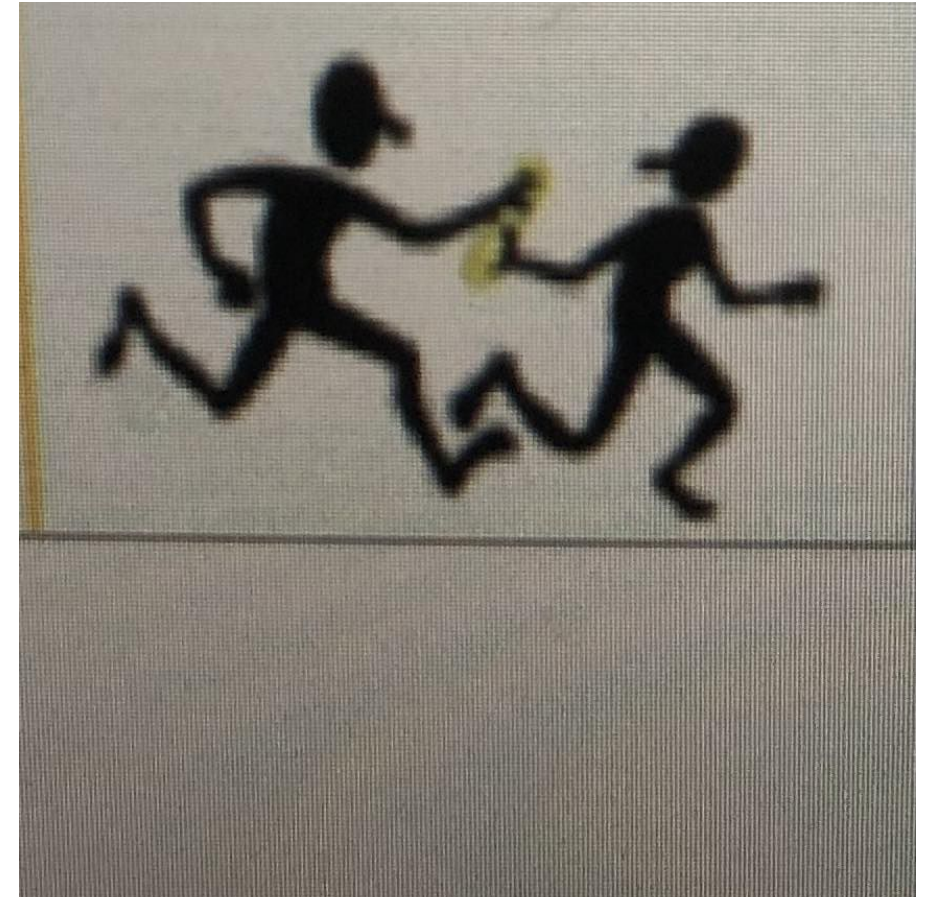
This is the stage in which close relationship among the members develop.

Strong senses of group identify and comradeship (share activities with members) also develops.



Performing stage:

- This stage is characterized by team work, role clarity and task accomplishment.
- This stage exhibits the highest level of group motivation.
- Conflicts among the members are resolved through group discussions.
- The members of the group are aware of group's process and the extent of their own involvement in the group.



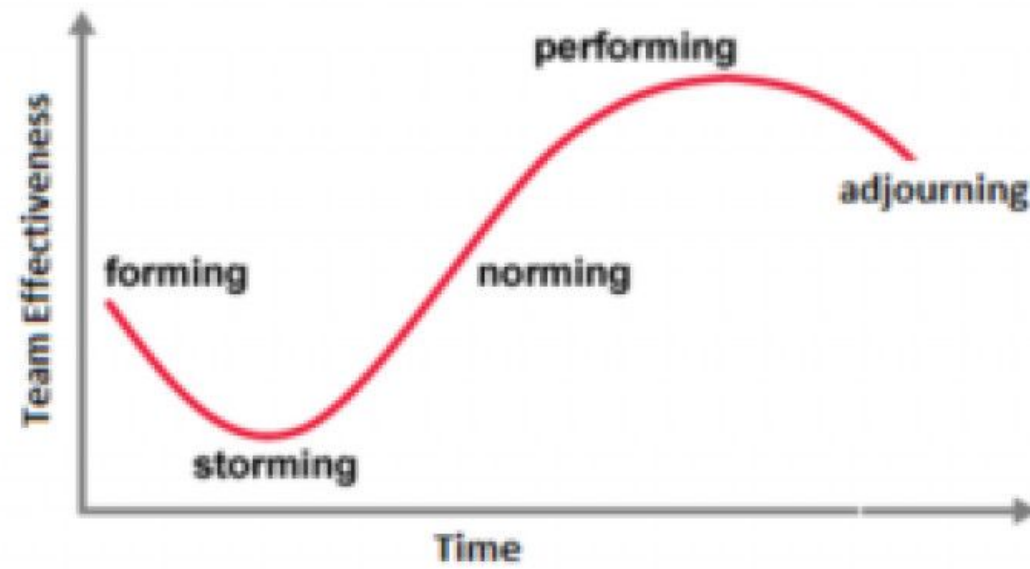
Adjourning stage: (break off)

- This stage is relevant for work teams, task forces and such similar groups that have only a limited task to perform.
- As soon as the task is completed the activities of the group are wrapped.
- Reasons - the groups has completed its task.
- the members decide to disband (break up) and close the group with sentimental feelings.



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THANK YOU

QUESTIONS